

▲ **'THE HAPPY SPACE: BUILDING A POSITIVE WORK ENVIRONMENT'**

TAKEAWAYS

1

"Four things are important: the organisation must be caring, it should be progressive and inclusive, it must create empowered roles, and employees must feel fulfilled"

N.S. RAJAN
Former CEO, IDFC Foundation and former Group CHRO, Tata Sons

2

"We need to understand that we are dealing with occupants, not physical infrastructure. We need to create workspaces, not workstations"

VISTASP BHAGWAGAR
MD and Principal Architect, Vistasp & Associates

3

"Engagement at the workplace comes when we are more open to each other. When we are more open, we can interact more meaningfully"

PRAVIN CHATURVEDI
Chief Meaning Officer, Happiitude

or bigger milestones.

Notably, IAS officer Deependra Singh Kushwah, who is currently serving as Development Commissioner (Industries), Maharashtra, explained the importance of happiness at government institutions, pointing out that happy policymakers can draft and implement rules more mindfully and efficiently. "The first thing that crosses my mind is, is it the government's job to make people happy? It certainly is. Our actions and policies must be framed keeping this in mind," he said.

The toppers of the Happiness at Workplace Awards were decided by market research organisation Marketing and Development Research Associates (MDRA), which came up with a list of nominations and the parameters for ranking organisations. Companies were analysed on the basis of combined scores on the Objective survey and Perceptual survey. After the rankings, a jury meeting consisting of top management representatives from INDIA TODAY and RPG was held to determine the winners in eight categories (see *Happiest of the Happy*).

Two sessions—by Yogesh Chabria, founder, The Happionaire Way, and standup comedian Atul Khatri—brightened the evening. While Chabria spoke about how happiness is linked to core wellbeing, Khatri had everyone in splits with his boardroom jokes, drawing the INDIA TODAY-RPG Group Happiness at Workplace Summit and Awards to a cheerful close. ■